A Light for the Night Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 4

A deep shadow crossed the inlet. Nib called it a very solid blockage. Lark stood where the guide showed the channel, but the dark patch hid its surface. Before deciding what stopped the water, they needed a better view of what was actually there.

“A very solid shadow,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A shadow we can look behind,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inside**

“Igh writes long i in light and night,” Lark modeled clearly. “Keep the three-letter team together. Moonlight joins moon and light into one compound. Read the parts, rejoin them, and check that the whole word fits what it describes.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try night, light, moonlight. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read light on the inspection card,” Lark invited gently. “Where can the supported lamp illuminate the inlet without moving its water or cover?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The light is on. I can see the inlet.**

“What does the light help the speaker see?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the light repairs anything?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the lamp on a broad dry ledge. Light reached behind the shadow. Some water passed through, but less than the guide's ordinary-flow picture showed. The shadow had been a viewing problem, not proof of a blockage. The crew kept the low-flow observation and prepared to inspect the bank more closely.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write light beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the new observation beneath the first question. The lamp stayed on its real ledge. A keeper's older work record identified the corner where the inlet access cover could be reached.